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Electronic component management method, and housing body for electronic components

Abstract

An electronic component management method includes manufacturer-side steps including storing electronic components in a housing body that includes an RFID tag, writing in the RFID tag at least one piece of manufacturer-side information related to the electronic components stored in the housing body, shipping the housing body with the manufacturer-side information written in the RFID tag, and storing the electronic components, and user-side steps including receiving the shipped housing body, reading the manufacturer-side information written in the RFID tag, a preparing an electronic circuit board, and arranging the electronic components on the electronic circuit board based on the read manufacturer-side information.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application claims the benefit of priority to Japanese Patent Application No. 2020-205229 filed on Dec. 10, 2020 and is a Continuation Application of PCT Application No. PCT/JP2021/038085 filed on Oct. 14, 2021. The entire contents of each application are hereby incorporated herein by reference.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

1. Field of the Invention

(1) The present invention relates to an electronic component management method and an electronic component housing body.

2. Description of the Related Art

(2) Conventionally, in component manufacturers for manufacturing small electronic components, such as semiconductor chips and capacitor chips, a plurality of manufactured electronic components are stored in a single housing body, transported and stored in a factory, and shipped with the housing body to a manufacturer of assembled products. Examples of the housing body include a carrier tape in which electronic components are divided and held one by one and wound around a reel, a magazine in which electronic components are aligned and stored, a bulk case or bagging method in which electronic components are stored in a loose state, that is, in a bulk state (see, for example, Japanese Unexamined Patent Application, Publication No. 2005-324839). On the other hand, in order to perform production management of articles, there is a known technology in which an RFID tag is attached to an individual to be managed, and an RFID system that reads ID information preset in the RFID tag is used (see, for example, Japanese Unexamined Patent Application, Publication No. 2002-358494).

(3) As the size of an electronic component is significantly reduced, it is considered that the housing body is managed in order to manage a large amount of electronic components. However, the Japanese Unexamined Patent Application, Publication No. 2005-324839 and Japanese Unexamined Patent Application, Publication No. 2002-358494 do not mention the point of the housing body being managed in various forms, and there is room for improvement.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(4) Preferred embodiments of the present invention provide electronic component management methods and electronic component housing bodies that are each able to provide various management forms for a housing body in which a plurality of electronic components are stored, at least on the manufacturer-side.

(5) An electronic component management method according to a preferred embodiment of the present invention includes manufacturer-side steps performed at a manufacture side facility that manufactures electronic components, the manufacturer-side steps including housing a plurality of electronic components in a housing body that includes an RFID tag, writing at least one piece of manufacturer-side information related to the plurality of electronic components housed in the housing body in the RFID tag, and shipping the housing body in which the manufacturer-side information is written in the RFID tag and the plurality of electronic components are housed, and user-side steps performed at a user-side facility that uses the plurality of electronic components, the user-side steps including receiving the shipped housing body, reading the manufacturer-side information written in the RFID tag, providing an electronic circuit board, and placing each of the plurality of electronic components on the electronic circuit board based on the read manufacturer-

side information.

(6) An electronic component housing body according to a preferred embodiment of the present invention includes a plurality of electronic components manufactured by a manufacturer housed therein, and an RFID tag that records at least one piece of manufacturer-side information related to each of the plurality of electronic components, in which the manufacturer manages product information of the plurality of electronic components based on the manufacturer-side information, and a user of the plurality of electronic components places each of the plurality of electronic components on an electronic circuit board based on the manufacturer-side information.

(7) According to preferred embodiments of the present invention, it is possible to provide electronic component management methods and electronic component housing bodies that are each able to provide various management forms for a housing body in which a plurality of electronic components are stored, at least on the manufacturer-side.

(8) The above and other elements, features, steps, characteristics and advantages of the present invention will become more apparent from the following detailed description of the preferred embodiments with reference to the attached drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a schematical perspective view of electronic components and a bulk case according to a preferred embodiment of the present invention.

(2) FIG. 2 is a plan view of an RFID tag according to a preferred embodiment the present invention.

(3) FIG. 3 is a diagram of a management method of electronic components according to a preferred embodiment the present invention, and is a diagram showing a flow of the electronic components at a component manufacturer and a manufacturer of assembled products.

(4) FIG. 4 shows a hardware configuration to manage electronic components provided at the component manufacturer and the manufacturer of assembled products according to a preferred embodiment the present invention.

(5) FIG. 5 is a perspective view of an example of a method of reading information of an RFID tag of a bulk case at the component manufacturer.

(6) FIG. 6 is a perspective view of an example of a method of reading information of an RFID tag of a bulk case picked from a storage location at the component manufacturer.

(7) FIG. 7 is a perspective view of a bulk case to which a label is attached on the component manufacturer-side.

(8) FIG. 8 is a perspective view of an example of a packing method of a plurality of bulk cases when the bulk case is shipped.

(9) FIG. 9 is a perspective view of a case where RFID tags are read during transportation of a plurality of bulk cases packaged at the time of shipment.

(10) FIG. 10 is a perspective view of another method of reading RFID tags at the time of shipment.

(11) FIG. 11 is a perspective view of a bulk case in which an identification seal is attached to a label on a manufacturer on an assembled products side.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENTS

(12) Hereinafter, preferred embodiments of the present invention will be described with reference to the drawings. FIG. 1 shows a bulk case **20** defining and functioning as a housing body according to a preferred embodiment of the present invention and electronic components **10** housed in the bulk case **20**. FIG. 2 shows an example of a configuration of an RFID tag **30** included in the bulk case **20**. FIG. 3 shows a flow in which a plurality of bulk cases **20** that each house a plurality of electronic components **10** are shipped from a component manufacturer G that manufactures the

electronic components **10**, and the plurality of bulk cases **20** that have been shipped are shipped into a manufacturer of assembled products **S** for use. FIG. **4** shows a hardware configuration to manage the electronic components **10** included in each of the component manufacturer **G** and the manufacturer of assembled products **S**. The component manufacturer **G** is an example of a manufacturer-side facility. The manufacturer of assembled products **S** is an example of a user-side facility using the electronic components **10**.

(13) As shown in FIG. **1**, the bulk case **20** is a box body made of a rigid body such as, for example, resin and has a thin rectangular or substantially rectangular parallelepiped shape. The bulk case **20** houses, for example, several thousands to several tens of thousands of electronic components **10** in a loose state, i.e., a bulk state. The bulk case **20** includes an RFID tag **30**. The RFID tag **30** includes an elongated adhesive seal, and is attached to one end surface of the bulk case **20** or accommodated in the bulk case **20**.

(14) The electronic components **10** according to the present preferred embodiment are each, for example, a capacitor, an inductor, or the like, and are, for example, each a small rectangular or substantially rectangular parallelepiped electronic component having a longitudinal length of about 1.2 mm or less.

(15) As shown in FIG. **2**, the RFID tag **30** is a passive transponder including a rectangular or substantially rectangular sheet **30a** that is made of, for example, resin and defines and functions as a base material, an RFID chip **30b** including a semiconductor integrated circuit, and a plurality of antennas **30c** to communicate with an external device. The RFID chip **30b** and the antenna **30c** are attached to the sheet **30a**. The RFID tag **30** may be of a type in which the RFID chip **30b** and the antenna **30c** are embedded in the sheet **30a**. Alternatively, the RFID tag **30** may include a power source. The RFID chip **30b** includes, for example, a CPU, memory, a communication circuit, and the like. The RFID tag **30** of the present preferred embodiment has a unique ID.

(16) The RFID tag **30** may be of a type in which memory cannot be rewritten (RO: Read Only), a type in which memory can be re-written only once (WORM: Write Once Read Many), or a type in which memory can be rewritten (R/W: Read and Write), for example. In a case where the type of the RFID tag **30** is RO or WORM, the cost is low although information to be written is smaller than that of R/W.

(17) As shown in FIG. **3**, the component manufacturer **G** includes a writer **40** capable of writing manufacturer-side information, which is information relating to the component manufacturer **G** side, to the RFID tag **30** provided in the bulk case **20**, a reader **42** to read the manufacturer-side information recorded in the RFID tag **30** provided in the bulk case **20**, and a database server **44**. The writer **40** and the reader **42** may be integrated with each other to establish a reader/writer.

(18) The writer **40** includes a plurality of RFID writers **41** capable of writing information in a non-contact manner. Each of the plurality of RFID writers **41** is provided at a predetermined position in the factory of the component manufacturer **G**. The RFID writers **41** each write and record the manufacturer-side information read from the database server **44** in the RFID tag **30** in a non-contact manner. The reader **42** includes a plurality of RFID readers **43** capable of reading manufacturer-side information in a non-contact manner. Each of the plurality of RFID readers **43** is provided at a predetermined position in the factory of the component manufacturer **G**. The read information of the RFID reader **43** is inputted to the database server **44**.

(19) The manufacturer of assembled products **S** includes a writer **50** capable of writing user-side information, which is information relating to the manufacturer of assembled products **S** side, to the RFID tag **30** provided in the bulk case **20**, a reader **52** to read manufacturer-side information and user-side information recorded in the RFID tag **30** provided in the bulk case **20**, a database server **54**, and a mounter **56**. When the type of the RFID tag **30** is WORM, the writer **50** may be omitted.

(20) The writer **50** includes a plurality of RFID writers **51** capable of writing information in a non-contact manner. Each of the plurality of RFID writers **51** is provided at a predetermined position in the factory of the manufacturer of assembled products **S**. The RFID writers **51** each write and

record predetermined user-side information in the RFID tag **30** among the user-side information held by the database server **54**. The reader **52** includes a plurality of RFID readers **53** capable of reading manufacturer-side information and user-side information in a non-contact manner. Each of the plurality of RFID readers **53** is provided at a predetermined position in the factory of the component manufacturer G. The read information of the RFID reader **53** is inputted to the database server **54**.

(21) The mounter **56** includes a plurality of component supply devices **57**. In each component supply device **57**, the bulk case **20** is set, and the electronic components **10** in the bulk case **20** are supplied. Each component supply device **57** is a device to incorporate at least one electronic component **10** into an electronic device set.

(22) The component manufacturer G houses the plurality of electronic components **10** manufactured in the factory in the bulk case **20**, conveys and stores them, and ships them to the manufacturer of assembled products S. The manufacturer of assembled products S receives the plurality of shipped bulk cases **20** and incorporates the electronic components **10** accommodated in each of the bulk cases **20** into the electronic device set by the mounter **56**.

(23) Examples of the electronic device set to be manufactured by the manufacturer of assembled products S include information terminal devices such as smartphones and tablets, and components such as electronic circuit boards of such devices.

(24) The database server **44** on the component manufacturer G side and the database server **54** on the manufacturer of assembled products S side can be connected to a cloud **60** on the Internet. The cloud **60** is an example of a server. A portion of the information stored in the database server **44** of the component manufacturer G side is also stored in the cloud **60** on the Internet. A portion of the information stored in the database server **54** of the manufacturer of assembled products S side is also stored in the cloud **60** on the Internet. Both the component manufacturer G and the manufacturer of assembled products S can share both pieces of information by accessing the cloud **60**.

(25) The component manufacturer G performs a packaging process, an inspection process, and a shipping process of the electronic components **10**. In the manufacturer of assembled products S, a receiving process of the electronic components **10**, a manufacturing process including storage and dispensing, and a processing process are performed. The flow of the electronic components **10** in the component manufacturer G and the manufacturer of assembled products S will now be described with reference to FIG. 4.

(26) Manufacturer-side Steps at Component Manufacturer G

(27) In the packaging process, a plurality of manufactured electronic components **10** are housed in the bulk case **20** (Step S101). In the RFID tag **30** of the bulk case **20** in which the plurality of electronic components **10** are housed, a plurality of pieces of manufacturer-side information that are set or held on the component manufacturer G side in relation to the housed electronic components **10** is recorded by a predetermined RFID writer **41** (Step S102). Examples of the manufacturer-side information recorded in the RFID tag **30** include a lot number of the electronic component **10**, an amount of the electronic components **10** stored in the bulk case **20**, product information related to the electronic component **10**, environmental information related to the electronic component **10**, an ID number of the bulk case **20**, and an inspection number of the electronic component **10**. Depending on the kind of the electronic component **10**, for example, MSL (Moisture Sensitivity Level) is recorded. The MSL is a level indicating a risk for a phenomenon whereby volume expansion due to vaporization of moisture contained in the electronic component **10** occurs to cause a failure.

(28) Next, a predetermined RFID reader **43** reads the information recorded in the RFID tag **30** of one bulk case **20**, for example, reads a unique ID (Step S103). The manufacturer-side information recorded in the RFID tag **30** is associated with each bulk case **20**, and the information is stored in the database server **44**. In order to read the information of the RFID tag **30**, for example, as shown

in FIG. 5, the RFID tag **30** of the bulk case **20** placed on the table **61** is read by the RFID reader **43** placed on the table **61**.

(29) The plurality of bulk cases **20** from each of which the unique ID of the RFID tag **30** is read are carried in the factory and stored in a predetermined storage location (Step **S104**). Then, until the next inspection/processing process starts, for example, inventory information management, location management based on a movement path, security management, and the like are performed in the factory based on the manufacturer-side information recorded in the RFID tag **30**. The inventory information management, the location management, and the security management are performed based on the reading information of the RFID reader **43** provided in the factory. The RFID reader **43** is provided at, for example, a gate in a passage, an entrance/exit port to the room, or the like, and reads manufacturer-side information recorded in the RFID tag **30** when the bulk case **20** passes through the RFID reader **43**.

(30) The inventory information management refers to managing an inventory by checking whether or not the bulk case **20** is stored in a predetermined storage location. For example, when the RFID tag **30** passes through a gate at an entrance/exit port to a predetermined storage location, the RFID tag **30** is read by the RFID reader **43** at the gate, thus confirming that the RFID tag **30** is in stock in the inventory.

(31) The location management refers to a management in which the position of the bulk case **20** in the factory is grasped one by one by allowing the bulk case **20** carried in the factory to pass through a plurality of gates or enter and exit a predetermined room.

(32) The security management refers to a management in which, for example, when one bulk case **20** is out of the factory in a state in which shipping is not confirmed by, for example, the RFID tag **30**, it is determined that the bulk case **20** is not shipped on a regular route, and a warning is issued.

(33) In the inspection/shipment process, the bulk case **20** is picked from the storage location (Step **S105**), and the manufacturer-side information recorded in the RFID tag **30** is read (Step **S106**).

(34) For example, as shown in FIG. 6, the bulk case **20** is picked up from a storage place **62** such as a storage shelf and placed on a cart **63** for transportation, and on the cart **63**, the manufacturer-side information recorded on the RFID tag **30** is read by the RFID reader **43** via a sensor **64**. The RFID reader **43** is installed at an appropriate position of the cart **63**. Thus, the fact that the bulk case **20** is shipped is inputted to the database server **44**. When the bulk case **20** is spaced apart from the readable distance of the RFID reader **43**, the manufacturer-side information recorded in the RFID tag **30** may be read through the sensor **64** near the bulk case **20**.

(35) In the RFID tag **30** of the picked bulk case **20**, for example, the part number used by the manufacturer of assembled products S, the order number from the manufacturer of assembled products S, the factory number of the component manufacturer G, the date of manufacturing, the vendor number, and the like are written as new manufacturer-side information by the RFID writer **41** (Step **S107**).

(36) In the present preferred embodiment, as shown in FIG. 7, a label **71** is attached to the bulk case **20** (Step **S108**). On the label **71**, at least one piece of manufacturer-side information among the manufacturer-side information written in the RFID tag **30**, or manufacturer-side information required at the time of shipping is printed. The manufacturer-side information printed on the label **71** can be visually confirmed. The label **71** may include at least one of a one-dimensional barcode and a two-dimensional barcode associated with the manufacturer-side information.

(37) The unique ID of the RFID tag **30** of each bulk case **20** is read by the RFID reader **43**, and the bulk case **20** is inspected (Step **S109**).

(38) The plurality of bulk cases **20** that have been inspected are packaged in boxes and shipped to the manufacturer of assembled products S (Step **S110**). For example, as shown in FIG. 8, a predetermined number of the bulk case **20** is housed in one exterior box **81**, a plurality of exterior boxes **81** are housed in one transport outer box **82** in a two-stage stacked state, and a plurality of transport outer boxes **82** are stacked on a pallet **83**.

(39) The exterior boxes **81** each may include the RFID tag **31**. The transport outer boxes **82** each may include the RFID tag **32**. The pallet **83** may include the RFID tag **33**. As a result, information related to the stored bulk cases **20** can be recorded in the RFID tags **31**, **32**, and **33** for each of the exterior box **81**, the transport outer box **82**, and the pallet **83**, and can be collectively managed by being linked to a plurality of bulk cases **20** packaged.

(40) When the plurality of transport outer boxes **82** are stacked on the pallet **83** as described above, the pallet **83** is conveyed to a shipping place by a forklift **65** as shown in FIG. **9**. When the forklift **65** passes through the gate **66**, the RFID reader **43** reads the RFID tags **31**, **32**, and **33** via the sensor **64** at the gate **66**, thus making it possible to perform shipping management to confirm that the plurality of bulk cases **20** associated with the RFID tags **31**, **32**, and **33** have been shipped.

(41) FIG. **10** shows another mode of reading the RFID tag **30** at the time of shipment. In FIG. **10**, the RFID reader **43** reads the RFID tag **30** via the sensor **64** at the gate **68** while the exterior box **81** that houses the bulk cases **20** being transported by the transport table **67** is transported in the tunnel-shaped gate **68**.

(42) Referring back to FIG. **4**, the flow of the electronic components **10** on the side of the manufacturer of assembled products S will be described.

(43) User-side Steps in Manufacturer of Assembled Products S

(44) At the beginning of the receiving process, the bulk cases **20** are shipped to the manufacturer of assembled products S (Step S111). The RFID tag **30** of each of the received bulk cases **20** is read by a predetermined RFID reader **53** of the manufacturer of assembled products S (Step S112). Thus, the shipping management to confirm that the electronic component **10** has been received and the inspection of the electronic components **10** are performed. When a defect occurs in the course of the inspection, the bulk case **20** may be returned to the component manufacturer G.

(45) Predetermined usage side information required by the manufacturer of assembled products S is written in the RFID tag **30** as additional information in each of the plurality of received bulk cases **20** that have been shipped (Step S113). Identification information for use by the manufacturer of assembled products S is written as additional information in each RFID tag **30**.

(46) In the present preferred embodiment, as shown in FIG. **11**, the unique identification seal **72** on the manufacturer of assembled products S side is attached to the bulk case **20** (Step S114). The identification seal **72** is a seal having one color among the single colors such as, for example, red, blue, and yellow, and may be attached to the label **71**. Depending on the color of the identification seal **72**, a differentiated procedure in the manufacturer of assembled products S is performed on the bulk case **20**. For example, a manufacturing line, a manufacturing order, and the like are selected for each color of the identification seal **72**.

(47) In a case where the bulk case **20** is stored in a predetermined storage location or is picked and carried from the storage location before the transition to the manufacturing process in the manufacturer of assembled products S, similarly to the component manufacturer G, the manufacturer-side information and the user-side information of the RFID tag **30** can be read on the manufacturer of assembled products S side to perform, for example, inventory information management, location management, security management, and the like.

(48) In the manufacturing process, each of the bulk cases **20** is dispensed toward the mounter **56** to place the electronic components **10** on the electronic circuit board of the electronic device set, and is set in the component supply device **57**. In each component supply device **57**, the RFID tag **30** of each of the bulk cases **20** is read to check the components (Step S115). For example, when the bulk case **20** that houses components not suitable for the component supply device **57** is set, the component supply device **57** does not operate, the bulk case **20** is detached from the component supply device **57**, and the next bulk case **20** is set.

(49) The electronic components **10** are supplied from the bulk case **20** set in the component supply device **57** to the mounter **56** one by one, and the electronic components **10** are mounted on the electronic circuit board (Step S116). When all of the electronic components **10** in the bulk case **20**

are mounted, the empty bulk case **20** is detached from the component supply device **57** and discarded (Step **S117**). The empty bulk case **20** may be returned to the component manufacturer **G** for reuse.

(50) In the processing process after the manufacturing process, for example, the bulk case **20** in which the electronic components **10** remain is stored in a predetermined place as a midway inventory. In this case, the RFID tag **30** of each of the bulk cases **20** is read by the RFID reader **53**, and the remaining amount is managed for the bulk case **20** in the middle inventory (Step **S118**).

(51) In addition, in the processing process, by reading the RFID tag **30** of the bulk case **20**, it is possible to perform manufacturing tendency management based on, for example, the kind of the electronic component **10** to be used, the amount of the electronic device set to be manufactured, and security management of the bulk case **20**. The additional information in Step **S113** and the user-side information required in Step **S118** may be stored in the cloud **60**. The additional information in Step **S113** stored in the cloud **60** and the user-side information required in Step **S118** may be accessible from the component manufacturer **G** side. By making accessible from the component manufacturer **G** side, the component manufacturer **G** can grasp the specification mode and inventory information of the manufacturer of assembled products **S**, so that it is possible to predict in advance the request of the manufacturer of assembled products **S**, and thus it is possible to flexibly deal with the request of the manufacturer of assembled products **S**. Data stored on the cloud **60** may be stored using a block chain. The use of the block chain makes it difficult to tamper with the data stored on the cloud **60**, thus increasing the reliability of the data stored on the cloud **60**.

(52) According to the present preferred embodiments described above, the following advantageous effects are achieved. The electronic component management method of the electronic components **10** according to the present preferred embodiment includes the manufacturer-side steps performed at the component manufacturer **G** that manufactures electronic components **10**, the steps including housing a plurality of electronic components **10** in the bulk case **20** defining and functioning as a housing body that houses the plurality of electronic components **20** and includes the RFID tag **30**, writing at least one piece of manufacturer-side information related to the plurality of electronic components **10** housed in the bulk case **20** in the RFID tag **30**, and shipping the bulk case **20** in which the manufacturer-side information is written in the RFID tag **30** and the plurality of electronic components **10** are housed, and user-side steps performed at the manufacturer of assembled products **S** defining and functioning as a user-side facility that uses the plurality of electronic components **10**, the steps including receiving the shipped bulk case **20**, reading the manufacturer-side information written in the RFID tag **30**, providing an electronic circuit board, and placing each of the plurality of electronic components **10** on the electronic circuit board based on the read manufacturer-side information.

(53) With such a configuration, it is possible to provide various management processes at least on the component manufacturer **G** side by using the RFID tag **30** included in the bulk case **20** for the bulk case **20** in which the plurality of electronic components **10** are housed. In the present preferred embodiment, it is also possible to provide various management processes by using the RFID tag **30** on the manufacturer of the assembled products **S** side where the bulk case **20** including the RFID tag **30** is received. Furthermore, it is possible, by using the RFID tag **30**, to manage the components from the component manufacturer **G** to the manufacturer of assembled products **S** in a consistent manner.

(54) In the present preferred embodiment, the manufacturer-side information recorded in the RFID tag **30** includes, for example, at least one of the lot number of the electronic component **10**, the amount of the electronic components **10** stored in the bulk case **20**, the product information relating to the electronic component **10**, the environmental information relating to the electronic component **10**, the ID number of the bulk case **20**, or the inspection number of the electronic component **10**.

(55) This makes it possible to manage the electronic components **10** for each bulk case **20** with

respect to the amount of the electronic components **10**, the product information related to the electronic components **10**, the environmental information relating to the electronic components **10**, the ID number of the bulk case **20**, the inspection number of the electronic components **10**, and the like.

(56) In the present preferred embodiment, the manufacturer-side information recorded in the RFID tag **30** further includes the part number for use in the manufacturer of assembled products S, the order number from the manufacturer of assembled products S, the factory number of the component manufacturer G, the date related to manufacturing, the vendor number, and the like.

(57) With such a configuration, it is possible to manage the electronic components **10** for each bulk case **20** with respect to the part number for use in the manufacturer of assembled products S, the order number from the manufacturer of assembled products S, the factory number of the component manufacturer G, the date of manufacturing, the vendor number, and the like. Furthermore, it is possible to record the history of the electronic component information used for the electronic device set.

(58) In the present preferred embodiment, the user-side steps further includes writing additional information in the RFID tag **30**.

(59) With such a configuration, it is possible to newly add information necessary for the manufacturer of assembled products S to the RFID tag, and thus, it is possible to perform management using the RFID tag **30** at the manufacturer of assembled products S.

(60) In the present preferred embodiment, the additional information written to the RFID tag **30** by the manufacturer of assembled products S includes a unique ID for use in the manufacturer of assembled products S.

(61) With such a configuration, it is possible for the manufacturer of assembled products S to perform the solid identification, tracking management, and the like of the bulk case **20** for each bulk case **20** in association with the database server **54**.

(62) In the present preferred embodiment, the manufacturer-side steps further include storing in the database server **44** the manufacturer-side information written in the RFID tag **30** by the component manufacturer G in the cloud **60** on the Internet and the additional information written in the RFID tag **30** by the manufacturer of assembled products S in the database server **44**, and storing in the database server **54** at the component manufacturer G and the manufacturer of assembled products S, in which, at the component manufacturer G and the manufacturer of assembled products S, the manufacturer-side information and the additional information are readable from database servers **44** and **54**.

(63) With such a configuration, it is possible for the component manufacturer G and the manufacturer of assembled products S to know the information related to the other party side by accessing the cloud **60**. Therefore, for example, it is possible for the component manufacturer G to perform the prediction operation of appropriately adjusting the manufacturing pace of the electronic components **10** by grasping the inventory status of the electronic components **10** at the manufacturer of assembled products S.

(64) In the present preferred embodiment, the manufacturer-side steps further include reading the manufacturer-side information from the database server **44**.

(65) With such a configuration, it is possible to manage the electronic components **10** for each bulk case **20** based on the information unique to the component manufacturer G recorded in the database server **44**. The database server **44** need not necessarily be used, and all information may be exchanged via the RFID tag.

(66) The bulk case **20** defining and functioning as the housing body of the present preferred embodiment includes the plurality of electronic components **10** manufactured by the component manufacturer G, which is a manufacturer, housed therein, and the RFID tag **30** that records at least one piece of the manufacturer-side information related to each of the plurality of electronic components **10**, in which the component manufacturer G manages the product information of the

plurality of electronic components **10** based on the manufacturer-side information, and the manufacturer of assembled products **S**, which is a user of the plurality of electronic components **10**, places each of the plurality of electronic components **10** on an electronic circuit board based on the manufacturer-side information.

(67) With such a configuration, it is possible, by using the RFID tag **30**, to manage the plurality of components stored in the bulk case **20** from the component manufacturer **G** to the manufacturer of assembled products **S** in a consistent manner.

(68) Although preferred embodiments of the present invention have been described above, the present invention is not limited to the above-described preferred embodiments, and modifications, improvements, and the like are included in the present invention as long as the advantages and benefits of the present invention can be achieved.

(69) While preferred embodiments of the present invention have been described above, it is to be understood that variations and modifications will be apparent to those skilled in the art without departing from the scope and spirit of the present invention. The scope of the present invention, therefore, is to be determined solely by the following claims.

Claims

1. An electronic component management method comprising: manufacturer-side steps performed at a manufacture side facility that manufactures electronic components, the steps including: housing a plurality of electronic components in a housing body that includes an RFID tag; writing at least one piece of manufacturer-side information related to the plurality of electronic components housed in the housing body in the RFID tag; and shipping the housing body in which the manufacturer-side information is written in the RFID tag and the plurality of electronic components are housed; and user-side steps performed at a user-side facility that uses the plurality of electronic components, the steps including: receiving the shipped housing body; reading the manufacturer-side information written in the RFID tag; providing an electronic circuit board; and placing each of the plurality of electronic components on the electronic circuit board based on the read manufacturer-side information; wherein the housing body is a bulk case in which the plurality of electronic components are housed in a loose state; the RFID tag includes an elongated adhesive seal provided on the RFID tag; and the RFID tag is attached inside of the bulk case.

2. The electronic component management method according to claim 1, wherein the manufacturer-side information includes at least one of a lot number of each of the plurality of electronic components, an inspection number of the plurality of electronic components, or an ID number of the housing body.

3. The electronic component management method according to claim 1, wherein the manufacturer-side information includes a part number to be used in the user-side facility, an order number from the user, a factory number of the manufacturer, a date relating to manufacturing, and a vendor number.

4. The electronic component management method according to claim 1, wherein the user-side steps further include writing additional information in the RFID tag.

5. The electronic component management method according to claim 4, wherein the additional information includes a unique ID to be used in the user-side facility.

6. The electronic component management method according to claim 4, wherein the manufacturer-side steps further include storing, in a server, the manufacturer-side information written in the RFID tag in the manufacturer-side facility; the user-side steps further include storing, in the server, the additional information written in the RFID tag in the user-side facility; and the manufacturer-side information and the additional information are readable from the server in the manufacturer-side facility and the user-side facility.

7. The electronic component management method according to claim 1, wherein the manufacturer-

side steps further include reading the manufacturer-side information from a database.

8. The electronic component management method according to claim 1, wherein the bulk case is made of resin.

9. The electronic component management method according to claim 1, wherein the bulk case houses several thousands to several tens of thousands of the electronic components.

10. The electronic component management method according to claim 1, wherein the electronic components are each at least one of a capacitor or an inductor.

11. The electronic component management method according to claim 1, wherein the RFID tag is a passive transponder including a rectangular or substantially rectangular sheet.

12. An electronic component housing body comprising: a plurality of electronic components manufactured by a manufacturer housed therein; and an RFID tag to record at least one piece of manufacturer-side information related to each of the plurality of electronic components; wherein the electronic component housing body is a bulk case in which the plurality of electronic components are housed in a loose state; the RFID tag includes an elongated adhesive seal provided on the RFID tag; the RFID tag is attached inside of the bulk case; the manufacturer manages product information of the plurality of electronic components based on the manufacturer-side information; and a user of the plurality of electronic components places each of the plurality of electronic components on an electronic circuit board based on the manufacturer-side information.

13. The electronic component housing body according to claim 12, wherein the bulk case is made of resin.

14. The electronic component housing body according to claim 12, wherein the bulk case houses several thousands to several tens of thousands of the electronic components.

15. The electronic component housing body according to claim 12, wherein the electronic components are each at least one of a capacitor or an inductor.

16. The electronic component housing body according to claim 12, wherein the RFID tag is a passive transponder including a rectangular or substantially rectangular sheet.
